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4/21/80

~~SECRET~~

ROUTINE

*SRR 4130423 40080 1130236045SR 212205 APR 80

(S)

FEDERAL BUREAU OF INVESTIGATION

FM DIRECTOR FBI

TO 413

BT

~~SECRET~~

RASHAD A. KHALIFA:

(S) CAPTIONED SUBJECT IS UNDER INVESTIGATION BY FBI HOUSTON
FOR HIS ALLEGED ACTIVITY IN CONNECTION WITH PROPOSED LIBYAN
TERRORIST ACTIONS IN THE UNITED STATES. WE UNDERSTAND THROUGH
SECURE CONTACT WITH

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b7E

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b7E

IN VIEW OF ABOVE, APPRECIATE COPIES OF THESE DOCUMENTS
EITHER TELETYPED TO FBI ATTENTION TERRORISM SECTION, CRIMINAL
INVESTIGATIVE DIVISION OR COPIES SUPPLIED TO FBI LIAISON OFFICER
WHO ROUTINELY CAN PROVIDE SAME DOCUMENTS TO US. (U)

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LFS:JLM

4/21/80

4058

4656

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b7C

DATE: 06-26-2006
CLASSIFIED BY UC 60309 TAM/MLT/CAL
DECLASSIFY ON: 25X 3.3(1) 06-26-2031

~~SECRET~~

FOI # 334,230
APPEAL #
CAVIACT. #
E.O. # 12,958
DATE 6/1/06
(S) Reprographic Agency

0002 MRI 01302

PP RUEHFB FBIPX

DE FBILA #0005 0370001

ZNY SSSSS

P 052231Z FEB 90

FM FBI LOS ANGELES [REDACTED] (CT-1/SARA) (P)

b3
b7E

TO DIRECTOR FBI/PRIORITY/

FBI PHOENIX/PRIORITY/

BT

~~SECRET~~

CITE: //3410:0670//

PASS: ATTENTION SA [REDACTED] (TUCSON RA).

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SUBJECT: UNSUBS; POLITICAL ASSASSINATION OF RASHAD A. KHALIFA-
VICTIM; TUCSON ARIZONA; 1/31/90; OO: PHOENIX.

REFERENCE TELCAL BY SA [REDACTED] SARA TO SA [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] TUCSON RA, 1/31/90.

FOR INFORMATION OF PHOENIX, ON 1/31/90, [REDACTED]
CONTACTED THE SARA ADVISING THAT [REDACTED] RASHAD KHALIFA WAS
THE VICTIM OF A POLITICAL EXECUTION THAT MORNING IN TUCSON,
ARIZONA. [REDACTED] ADVISED THAT [REDACTED] WERE AFFILIATED

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PAGE TWO DE FBILA 0005 ~~SECRET~~

WITH A MOSLEM RELIGIOUS ORGANIZATION AND THAT THIS AFFILIATION WAS THE CAUSE OF [REDACTED] DEATH. [REDACTED] WAS SUBSEQUENTLY INTERVIEWED THAT MORNING AS HE APPEARED TO BE FEARFUL OF A SIMILAR ATTEMPT ON HIS OWN LIFE. HE EXPLAINED THAT [REDACTED] RASHAD WAS A MODERATE MOSLEM RELIGIOUS LEADER, WHO HAD FALLEN FROM FAVOR IN THE MOSLEM COMMUNITY. HE WAS IDENTIFIED AS NEITHER SUNNI NOR SHIITE IN RELIGIOUS BELIEF, BUT RATHER AN INDIVIDUAL WHO FOCUSED PRIMARILY ON THE TEACHINGS OF THE KORAN. RASHAD'S FATHER BEFORE HIM WAS AN IMAM IN EGYPT, AND RASHAD HIMSELF WAS AN IMAM WHO HAD A SMALL FOLLOWING IN THE TUCSON COMMUNITY. HIS TEACHINGS AND BELIEFS EARNED HIM BOTH NOTORIETY AND INVITATIONS TO SPEAK IN THE ARAB WORLD, AND ALONG WITH HIS SPEECHES AND PUBLICATIONS CAME CONTINUOUS DEATH THREATS AND ABUSIVE TELEPHONE CALLS. ACCORDING TO [REDACTED] THE PROPAGANDA ORGANS OF MOROCCO, ALGERIA, EGYPT, SAUDI ARABIA AND LIBYA ALL ROUTINELY ATTACKED HIM FOR HIS CONTROVERSIAL RELIGIOUS BELIEFS WHICH SUGGESTED THAT THE PROFIT MOHAMMED'S IMPORTANCE HAD BEEN OVER-EMPHASIZED AND IN MANY CASES FABRICATED DURING ISLAMIC HISTORY. FURTHERMORE, RASHAD KHALIFA CONSIDERED HIMSELF DIVINELY INSPIRED AND A MESSENGER OF GOD WHO CARRIED THE REAL MESSAGE OF ISLAM TO MOSLEMS.

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ACCORDING TO [] RASHAD WAS INVITED TO LIBYA APPROXIMATELY SEVEN YEARS AGO BY MUOMMAR KADDAFFI, IN ORDER TO PRESENT HIS CONTROVERSIAL VIEWS IN A SPEECH THERE. HOWEVER, HE WAS PROMPTLY ARRESTED AND JAILED BY LIBYAN SECURITY AGENTS WHEN HE LANDED IN THE COUNTRY AND ADVISED THAT HE WOULD BE KILLED BECAUSE OF HIS HERETICAL RELIGIOUS BELIEFS. HE WAS SUBSEQUENTLY RELEASED WITH A WARNING. CONSULAR OFFICIALS FROM SAUDI ARABIA ALSO REPORTEDLY PAID RASHAD A VISIT AFTER HE CRITICIZED THE PUBLIC EXECUTION OF THE SAUDI ROYAL PRINCESS AS BEING UNCALLED FOR BY ISLAMIC LAW. SAUDI OFFICIALS REPORTEDLY ASKED HIM TO MODERATE HIS VIEWS OFFERING HIM A SIGNIFICANT SUM OF MONEY FOR HIS TROUBLE. TWO PUBLICATIONS WERE IDENTIFIED BY [] AS RELIGIOUS JOURNALS THAT [] RASHAD DISTRIBUTED. THEY WERE IDENTIFIED AS THE "MOSLEM PERSPECTIVE" WHICH WAS SUBSEQUENTLY RENAMED THE "SUBMITTERS PERSPECTIVE."

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RASHAD RECEIVED NUMEROUS THREATS BY TELEPHONE. ON ONE RECENT OCCASION, WHILE [] WAS PRESENT, A MAN CLAIMING TO BE A JOURNALIST FROM CHICAGO, CALLED INQUIRING ABOUT RASHAD'S USE OF BODYGUARDS, SECURITY, ORGANIZATION AFFILIATIONS AND DAILY ROUTINE. [] EMPHASIZED THAT THIS INDIVIDUAL'S

PAGE FOUR DE FBILA 0005 ~~SECRET~~

CONTACT WITH [REDACTED] EXEMPLIFIED HOW VULNERABLE [REDACTED] WAS TO ANY EXTREMISTS WHO WISHED TO KILL HIM. [REDACTED] WAS UNABLE TO IDENTIFY ANY INDIVIDUAL OR ORGANIZATION RESPONSIBLE FOR

[REDACTED] MURDER, BUT IT WAS CLEAR DURING THE INTERVIEW THAT THE LIST OF POTENTIAL SUSPECTS WAS ENDLESS AS RASHAD WAS CLEARLY OUT OF THE MAINSTREAM IN ISLAMIC THEORY AND HAD OFFENDED MANY INDIVIDUALS DURING HIS RELIGIOUS TENURE. [REDACTED] IS

DESCRIBED AS FOLLOWS: [REDACTED] MALE, DATE OF BIRTH [REDACTED] HEIGHT

[REDACTED] WEIGHT [REDACTED] HAIR [REDACTED] EYES [REDACTED] SOCIAL SECURITY

ACCOUNT NUMBER [REDACTED] PLACE OF BIRTH [REDACTED]

OCCUPATION [REDACTED] ADDRESS [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] CALIFORNIA AND HOME TELEPHONE NUMBER [REDACTED]

PHOENIX SHOULD NOTE THAT LOS ANGELES INDICES HAVE NO RECORDS IDENTIFIABLE WITH THE VICTIM OR [REDACTED] FURTHERMORE, NEITHER MAN REPORTEDLY HAS ANY OTHER AFFILIATION WITH OTHER RELIGIOUS, POLITICAL GROUPS OR ORGANIZATIONS.

CLAS. BY 3R ORGANIZATION RESPONSIBLE FOR [REDACTED] MURDER, BUT IT WAS CLEAR DURING THE INTERVIEW THAT THE LIST OF POTENTIAL SUSPECTS WAS ENDLESS AS RASHAD WAS CLEARLY OUT OF THE MAINSTREAM IN ISLAMIC THEORY AND HAD OFFENDED MANY INDIVIDUALS DURING HIS RELIGIOUS TENURE. [REDACTED] IS DESCRIBED AS FOLLOWS:

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PAGE FIVE DE FBILA 0005 ~~SECRET~~

MALE, DATE OF BIRTH HEIGHT WEIGHT HAIR
 EYES SOCIAL SECURITY ACCOUNT NUMBER
PLACE OF

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(Mount Clipping in Space Below)

Mosque leader is found slain

Tucsonan was focus of religious uproar

By Carmen Duarte
The Arizona Daily Star

An internationally renowned and controversial Islamic leader was killed early yesterday morning in a Tucson mosque.

Imam Rashad Khalifa, 54, the founder and spiritual leader of the Masjid, or Mosque of, Tucson, 739 E. Sixth St., was found "in a kitchen area" by the mosque's secretary, authorities said.

Officials said Khalifa had received death threats because of his interpretation of the Koran, the sacred book of Moslems.

Khalifa, according to friends and associates, caused anger and hatred in the Islamic community because of his interpretation of the scriptures.

And a police homicide sergeant said there is a possibility his death may be connected to political or religious problems.

FBI involvement

The FBI was called in to help the Tucson Police Department because of the possibility Khalifa was slain because of political or religious beliefs.

Police responded to the mosque at 5:45 a.m. after a report of a shooting, authorities said.

Police would not confirm if Khalifa, who once was a science adviser to Libyan leader Col. Moammar Gadhafi, was shot or say what type of wounds Khalifa suffered.

Authorities said Khalifa "died a violent death."

The body was taken to the Pima County Medical Examiner's Office, where an autopsy was scheduled for today.

"Number of avenues"

"There is a possibility that motives (for the slaying) may include political and religious problems," said homicide Sgt. Charles Armijo of the Tucson Police Department.

"There are a number of avenues we're pursuing," Armijo said. "We are not limiting ourselves to any one specific lead or area at this point."

FBI Special Agent Larry Bagley, supervisor of the Tucson office, said agents will coordinate out-of-state leads and that the agency has offered police its laboratory services.

"Khalifa is a moderate Moslem who's made interpretations of the Koran that has angered many Mid-eastern Moslems," said a law enforcement official who asked not to be identified.

"He's been a high-profile person who has received death threats in the past," the official said.

Khalifa, an imam, or spiritual leader of the mosque, made a computer analysis of the Koran and wrote books about his findings.

See **SLAYING**, Page 4A

Slaying

Continued from Page One

friends and associates said.

Edip Yuksel, who was an assistant to Khalifa, said Khalifa arrived at the mosque at about 2 or 3 a.m. every day to work on his religious writings and translations of the Koran.

He said Khalifa, who founded the mosque, was well-known among Moslems because of a computer analysis of the Koran that showed a mathematical formula that Khalifa said proved that the Koran is divine scripture.

Khalifa wrote books about his finding, and also published a translation of the Koran in which he omitted two satanic verses, said a friend of Khalifa's who asked not to be identified.

Khalifa accused other Moslems of following a satanic Koran, an accusation that caused anger toward Khalifa and hatred of him, said the friend.

Khalifa also claimed to be a messenger of God, and mainstream Moslems believe that Mohammed was the last messenger, the friend said.

(Indicate page, name of newspaper, city and state.)

Date: 2/1/90
Edition: ARIZONA DAILY STAR
TUCSON, ARIZONA

Title:

Character:
or

80-307A

Classification:

Submitting Office: PHOENIX

Indexing:

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b7E

Khalifa continually preached that Moslems should not idolize Mohammed, Jesus Christ or saints, rather they should only worship God, said Yuksel.

Yuksel said Khalifa was "controversial from Turkey to Morocco and from Saudi Arabia to Iran."

Yuksel said he was "90 percent sure" that Khalifa's slaying was the work of a religious fanatic.

"I can't believe that it would be so soon," Yuksel said.

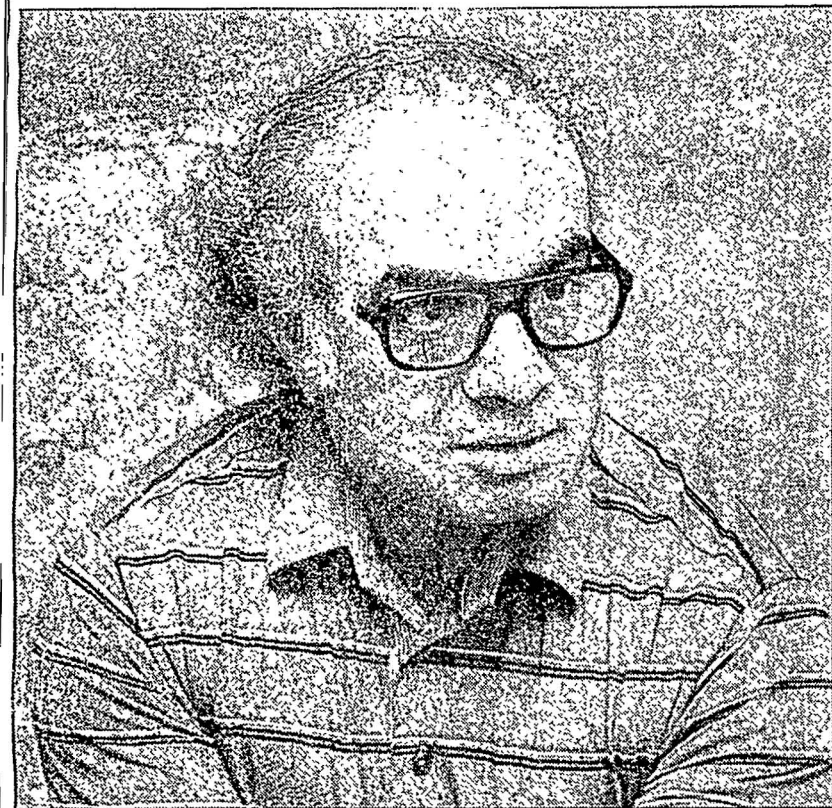
"He received a death threat a few

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TO TUCSON RA

ON 2/20/90

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FBI - PHOENIX	

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1989 Star photo

The controversial Imam Rashad Khalifa died violently

days ago," Yuksel said of Khalifa. He did not release further information on the threat, but said police knew about it. Police would not talk about the threat.

Anne Betteridge, a University of Arizona Middle Eastern studies professor, said Khalifa wasn't a mainstream Moslem.

"He did not recognize sectarian differences. He felt that all Moslems are Moslems," said Betteridge, executive secretary of the Middle East Association of North America.

Yuksel said there were about 300 Jews who worshiped at the mosque.

"We're all sorry about his death," Yuksel said. "We believe in the resurrection. We believe he went to heaven."

A few followers gathered yesterday afternoon and mourned at the mosque, which had a message on one of its walls that read: "Happiness is submission to God."

Khalifa had lived in Tucson more than 20 years. He moved to Tucson from Tanta, Egypt, to attend the University of Arizona. He received a doctorate in biochemistry from the University of California, where he taught for two years before spending six years in industrial research.



David Sanders, The Arizona Daily Star

Officer John Leavitt stands in front of the Tucson police barricade outside the mosque

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Rashad has a weekly, nationally syndicated 30-minute television program called "In Sport," described by an NBC spokesman yesterday as a show with a magazine format that focuses on sports entertainment.

Attempts to reach Rashad for comment yesterday were unsuccessful.

Stephanie Robinson, who identified herself as Rashad's assistant, said from her Washington, D.C., office yesterday that Rashad was "on location, filming" somewhere in California.

Khalifa

Continued from Page One

following a satanic Koran, an accusation that directed anger and hatred at him, said a friend.

Khalifa also claimed to be a messenger of God, and mainstream Moslems believe that Mohammed was the last messenger, the friend said.

According to friends and associates, Khalifa, who received a doctorate in biochemistry from the University of California, gained international attention after he made a computer analysis of the Koran and wrote books about his findings.

He used a computer to find a numerical code in the Koran based on the number 19 to show that the Koran is a divine scripture and God's message to the world, said Edit Yuksel, an associate of Khalifa's.

Khalifa's research began more than 20 years ago.

Khalifa's message will continue to be spread around the world according to God's will, read a prepared statement from worshipers at the mosque.

Khalifa, who moved to Tucson from Tanta, Egypt, more than 20 years ago, was a science adviser to Libyan leader Col. Moammar Gadhafi, according to a friend.

Arik said the FBI contacted the Tucson Police Department about three days before the killing about a murder plot.

Arik said the plot to kill Khalifa

originated in Salt Lake City and that he believed someone was arrested. He said police warned Khalifa about the plot.

Armijo denied that police told Khalifa about a plot.

Yesterday, FBI Special Agent James Screen, of Salt Lake City, and officers of other law enforcement agencies there denied knowing about a plot to kill Khalifa.

FBI Special Agent Larry Bagley, supervisor of the Tucson office, also denied knowing about the plot.

"We have not contacted the Police Department or Khalifa about any recent threats," Bagley said.

A law enforcement official, who did not want to be identified, said that several years ago, a plot to kill Khalifa was discovered. But the plot did not originate in Salt Lake City, the official added.

The official said that "some other agencies" knew about the plot, and that the Tucson Police Department was given the information.

"It may or may not be related to what happened now," the official said. "We will be looking into it."

Bagley said FBI agents will conduct out-of-state interviews on the case for the Tucson Police Department. He would not comment further.

Tucson police Lt. Anthony Daykin, community services division commander, said police are working with the FBI in gathering "intelligence on reports of (death) threats."

He said because of the "possible international implications the investigation will take some time."

Khalifa

Continued from Page One

National Forest.

The compound is near the town of Buena Vista, about 70 miles west of Colorado Springs.

Police seized attack weapons, including AK-47s, M-16s and M-14s, at the compound. Officers also found 21 children and three adults there.

The land was purchased by the sect, which had been at the compound for four years, said Chavez. He said his officers had been watching the compound for about two years.

"We've been monitoring them and have been concerned about stolen weapons and ammunition. Our main concern is the safety and security of our county," Chavez said.

He said investigators gathered information that about 30 people, both women and men, underwent military training at the compound, including the handling of weapons and hand-to-hand combat.

He said the children attended school on the compound, which also has a chapel, a mobile home and two houses.

The root word of FUQRA, according to the Arabic dictionary, means a "military unit or established unit deployed to terrorize or frighten people," said Abdullah Arik, who was Khalifa's assistant and who became the mosque's director after Khalifa's death.

Word of a possible link between the sect and Khalifa's slaying had not yet reached the small mosque that serves about 50 people, Arik said yesterday.

Khalifa's widow declined to comment.

Investigators said Khalifa had been stabbed numerous times. His .22-caliber handgun, which had not been fired, was found under his body.

At the time of the slaying, investigators were leaning toward the possibility that the killing may have been a religious assassination.

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George Chavez
Sheriff of Chaffee County, Colo.

Khalifa, who at one time was a science adviser to Libyan leader Col. Moammar Gadhafi, had received death threats because of his interpretation of the Koran — the sacred book of Muslims.

Followers have said his interpretation caused anger and hatred in the Islamic community.

According to friends and associates, Khalifa, who received a doctorate in biochemistry from the University of California, gained international attention after he made a computer analysis of the Koran and wrote books about his findings.

Khalifa preached that people must worship God and not Mohammed, Jesus Christ or saints. That basic tenet is painted in blue letters on the side of the small mosque — "Happiness is submission to God."

Worshippers at the mosque have tried to carry on normally since Khalifa's death, but even two years later, death threats are still left on the mosque's answering machine, Arik said.

Khalifa's followers were saddened and angered over their spiritual leader's slaying. But Arik said even though the "equality law" calls for an eye for an eye, "God says if you forget and forgive, it's better."

Arik says the mosque's members don't want retaliation.

"Whatever happens, happens in accordance with God's will. That was the time for Dr. Khalifa to go," Arik said. But he added that the killers "will suffer the consequences. Their destiny is hell if they don't repent."

Mosque leader is found slain

THU 1 FEB 1990
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See SLAYING, Page 4A

Slaying

THU 1 FEB 1990
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Khalifa also claimed to be a messenger of God, and mainstream Moslems believe that Mohammed was the last messenger, the friend said.

Khalifa continually preached that Moslems should not idolize Mohammed, Jesus Christ or saints, rather they should only worship God, said Yuksek.

Yuksek said Khalifa was "controversial from Turkey to Morocco and from Saudi Arabia to Iran."

Yuksek said he was "90 percent sure" that Khalifa's slaying was the work of a religious fanatic.

"I can't believe that it would be so soon," Yuksek said.

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The controversial Imam Rashad Khalifa

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THU. FEB. 1990
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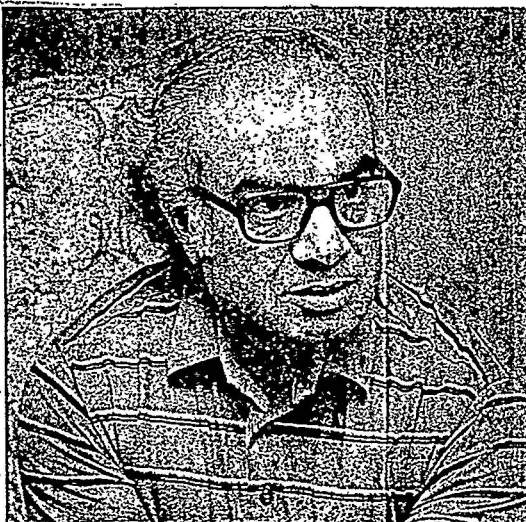
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